



Political Correspondent, Jan 2026).

The *Daily Mirror* is part of a regulatory framework known as the Independent Press Standards Organisation (IPSO) – an independent body which is not backed by the government and is fully funded by the industry itself. This is a regulatory body whose aim is to maintain press standards, but is anti-Leveson in its approach. It is not obligatory to join IPSO but the majority of newspaper publishers choose to be regulated by this organisation.

Theoretical perspectives

Power and media industries – Curran and Seaton

The newspaper industry is dominated by a small number of powerful companies. Reach plc was previously known as Trinity Mirror (1999-2018) and was rebranded as Reach plc after the acquisition of additional newspaper brands. Initially, there were concerns about the deal that brought about the new company, which was investigated by the Competition and Markets Authority. The concern is that the concentrated ownership model of the newspaper industry means that audiences receive a narrow range of viewpoints; indeed, the *Daily Mirror* is a relatively lone voice in a largely right-wing press.

Reach plc has maintained their position in the UK market despite falling sales of the *Daily Mirror* and other mainstream titles, by diversifying into regional news. This diverse pattern of ownership has allowed them to create the conditions for more varied and adventurous media products.

Regulation – Livingstone and Lunt (A Level)

Reach plc, alongside the rest of the UK press industry, faces increasing pressure to adhere to strict rules and regulations on industry practice. This arose after the phone hacking scandal and subsequent Leveson enquiry into the industry. There is an ongoing underlying issue of protecting citizens from harmful material while ensuring choice and press freedom.

Cultural industries – David Hesmondhalgh (A Level)

Reach plc is one of the UK's largest newspaper publishers and has become a horizontally integrated company with a wide range of titles in order to maximise audiences and minimise risks. Rather than seeing digital media as a threat, the company has embraced its digital expansion and now offers digital marketing as well as digital classifieds to generate additional income. They have also introduced a subscription for a tablet edition of the newspaper with an introductory offer of two free months. A daily download of the newspaper is available on iOS, Google Play, Amazon or Windows.

Starting points: Audiences

The following points should be considered in relation to the complete issue of the *Daily Mirror* and the online pages you have studied in class.

How audiences are grouped and categorised by media industries

It is important that newspapers have a clear idea of their **audience demographic** in order to produce content that will appeal to the target audience and their ideas and beliefs. Newspaper audiences, similarly to other media products, can be categorised in terms of age, gender and social class, as well as by lifestyle and taste. Regarding newspapers, the political allegiance of the audience is also a key factor.